

Week 6 Knowledge Check — Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

A short retention check covering the week's core ideas: stakeholder mapping (Power × Interest, RACI, watch lists), managing engagement, communicating technical trade-offs, AI-augmented meeting prep, and live negotiation. Answer each question, then check yourself against the key at the end. Aim for concepts, not trivia — every answer maps back to something we used in a lab.

Format: 12 questions (multiple choice + true/false). ~15 minutes. Individual or quad.

Questions

1. **(MC)** In the Power × Interest grid, which quadrant is called the "dangerous" or "surprise-veto" quadrant?

- A) High power, high interest
- B) Low power, high interest
- C) High power, low interest
- D) Low power, low interest

2. **(MC)** The RACI discipline for the five key decisions requires that each decision has:

- A) At least two Accountable owners, for redundancy
- B) Exactly one Accountable owner
- C) One Responsible and no Accountable
- D) The TPM as Accountable for every decision

3. **(T/F)** The org chart is a good enough starting point — a complete stakeholder map is essentially a copy of it.

4. **(MC)** Of the four engagement principles, which two are described as the *differentiators* (most TPMs do the other two by their second quarter in role)?

- A) Engage early + engage deliberately
- B) Match form to power + bidirectional asks
- C) Engage early + bidirectional asks
- D) One channel per stakeholder + engage early

5. (MC) Which quadrant do most rookie TPMs over-invest their attention in — because those stakeholders are easy to engage and ask for time?

- A) High power, high interest
- B) High power, low interest
- C) Low power, high interest
- D) Low power, low interest

6. (MC) "Match form to power" says a high-power, low-interest stakeholder should get:

- A) A crisp written update under ~250 words
- B) A weekly 30-minute sync
- C) A group email digest with the wider audience
- D) A quarterly newsletter

7. (MC) "Translating" a technical trade-off for a stakeholder primarily means:

- A) Using simpler, less technical words
- B) Re-framing it in the stakeholder's currency — cost, customer outcome, regulatory exposure, velocity
- C) Removing the cost so the decision sounds positive
- D) Adding more architectural detail so they trust you

8. (T/F) When predicting the stakeholder's top 5 questions for your 1-page brief, having all 5 come out friendly means the brief is well-prepared.

9. (MC) In the objection-map template, "the line we hold" should be:

- A) A general promise like "we'd compromise if needed"
- B) The smallest, specific ground you'd give up if the objection wins
- C) The list of everything you refuse to change
- D) The AI's recommended response

10. (T/F) AI is a reliable source for telling you what has already been decided about your product, so you can skip validating its prior-context summary.

11. (MC) The negotiation "trade space" is the set of axes, at least one of which must be able to move. If nothing can move, then:

- A) You have maximum leverage
- B) You're not negotiating — you're just saying yes or no
- C) You should add more non-negotiables
- D) You've automatically found the trade space

12. (T/F) In the live negotiation rubric, "Held the line where it mattered" is the single highest-weighted dimension.

Answer Key

1. C — High power, low interest: the surprise-veto quadrant. They hand you a "no" at the worst time, so they go on the watch list with a named trigger.

2. B — Exactly one Accountable per decision. If two people are A, neither is; if no one is A, the decision rots.

3. False — Org chart ≠ stakeholder map. Walk the five circles; complete lists run 10–18 names, and the usual omissions (compliance, finance) are exactly who blindside you.

4. B — Match form to power + bidirectional asks are the differentiators. Engaging early and deliberately is table stakes most TPMs reach by quarter 2.

5. C — Low power, high interest. They're comfortable to engage and they ask for your time — but the attention isn't strategic.

6. A — A crisp written update under ~250 words. High-power gets crisp writing; high-interest gets conversation.

7. B — Re-frame it in the stakeholder's currency. "Use simpler words" misses the point — CFO → cost, Customer Success → customer outcome, Compliance → regulatory exposure, Eng Director → velocity.

8. False — At least one predicted question should be hostile. If all 5 are friendly, you're not stress-testing the brief.

9. B — The smallest specific ground you'd give up if the objection wins. It's the senior-author signal — specific, not a vague "we'd compromise."

10. False — AI does that poorly. It can re-organize what you give it, but it can't tell you what's been decided or verify facts against production. Every output gets validated — "looks fine" without

opening the doc isn't validation.

11. B — You're not negotiating, you're saying yes or no. The trade space is scope / time / quality-resources; offer movement on a different axis than the one they care most about.

12. False — "Held the line" is 15%. "Listened first," "Translated tech to business," and "Found the trade space" each carry 20% — listening and translating outweigh holding the line.